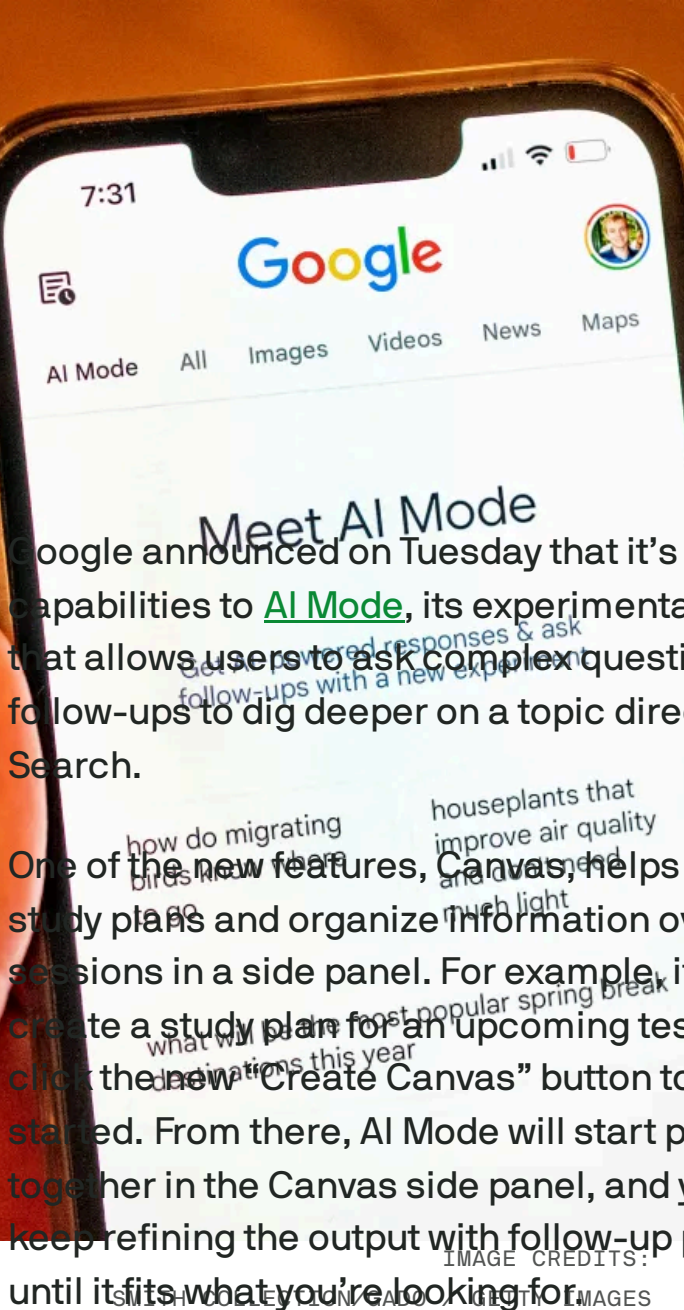


Advertisement

AI



Google's AI Mode gets new 'Canvas' feature, real-time help with Search Live, and more



Aisha Malik — 9:00 AM PDT · July 29, 2025

Google announced on Tuesday that it's adding new capabilities to [AI Mode](#), its experimental feature that allows users to ask complex questions and follow-ups to dig deeper on a topic directly within Search.

One of the new features, [Canvas](#), helps you build study plans and organize information over multiple sessions in a side panel. For example, if you want to create a study plan for an upcoming test, you can click the new "Create Canvas" button to get started. From there, AI Mode will start putting things together in the Canvas side panel, and you can keep refining the output with follow-up prompts until it fits what you're looking for.

Soon, you will also be able to upload files like class notes or a syllabus to customize your study guide. Users enrolled in the AI Mode Labs experiment in the U.S. will see Canvas in the coming weeks.

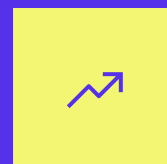
## TECH DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

## Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

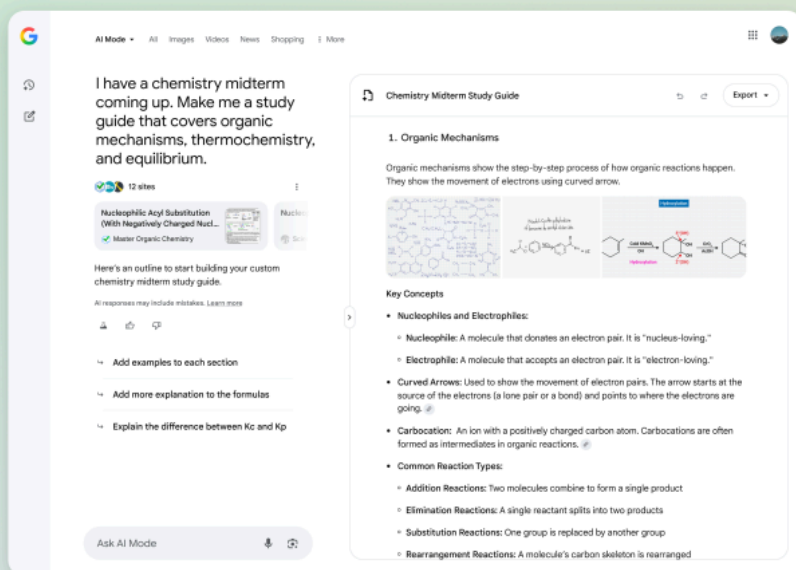


IMAGE CREDITS :GOOGLE

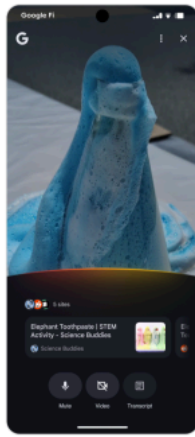
Google is also bringing Project Astra capabilities directly into AI Mode via Search Live, which is integrated with Google Lens, the tech giant’s visual search tool.

“When you go Live with Search, it’s like having an expert on speed dial who can see what you see and talk through tricky concepts in real-time, all with easy access to helpful links on the web,” wrote Robby Stein, VP of Product, Google Search, in a press release.

To use the feature, open Lens in the Google app, tap the Live icon, and ask a question while pointing the camera at something. With this feature, users can have a back-and-forth conversation with Search in AI Mode using visual context from their camera feed.

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren’t even dating apps

How can I make this more impressive?



Try using a taller and narrower container to make the foam shoot higher, adding more yeast, and using warm water to speed up the reaction.

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Search Live with video input is rolling out this week on mobile in the U.S. for users enrolled in the AI Mode Labs experiment.

**TC**

## Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

**REGISTER NOW**

In addition, Google announced that users will soon be able to use Lens in AI Mode to ask about what's on their desktop screen.

"Perhaps you're looking at a geometry problem and want to better understand one of the diagrams," Stein said. "Click on 'Ask Google about this page'

from the address bar and select the diagram. You'll get an AI Overview with a snapshot of key information directly in the side panel. And this week, you'll be able to follow up with more questions through AI Mode, by selecting AI Mode at the top of the Lens search results or by clicking the 'Dive deeper' button at the bottom of the AI Overview."

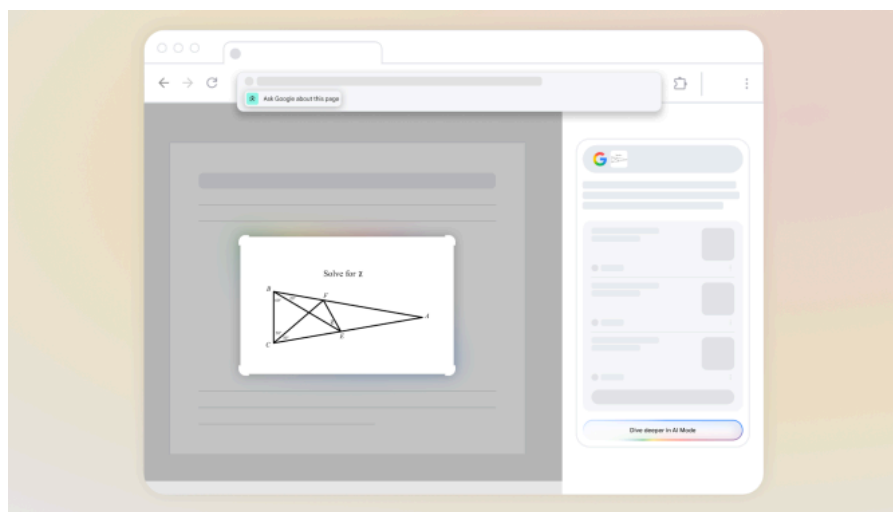


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Plus, while you can already use AI Mode in the Google app to ask questions about images, you can now do so on desktop as well. Google is also adding support for PDF uploads on desktop, letting you ask detailed questions about documents.

For example, you can upload PDF slides from a school lecture and ask follow-up questions to deepen your understanding beyond the class materials.

Google says AI Mode will support additional file types beyond PDFs and images later this year, including Google Drive files.

Topics: [AI](#) [ai mode](#) [Google](#)



**Aisha Malik**

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING



IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE



# Google introduces a set of iOS 16 Lock Screen widgets for your iPhone

Sarah Perez — 6:58 AM PDT · September 12, 2022

Google [announced](#) this morning it will bring access to a number of its popular apps, including Search, Maps, Gmail and more, to the iPhone's Lock Screen. With the updated version of Apple's mobile

operating system — [iOS 16, releasing today](#) — iPhone owners are now able to customize their device by adding widgets to their Lock Screen, instead of only their Home Screen, as before.

These mini widgets come in three sizes: circular and rectangular, which appear below the Lock Screen's clock, and inline, which appears above the clock as a line of text and symbols.

Google's widgets will take advantage of all three formats.

The company, in a blog post, previewed its iOS 16 widgets, which include a Search widget that lets you begin a Google search from the Lock Screen, even using your voice or camera (Google Lens). This widget will offer a Google Translate widget, as well.

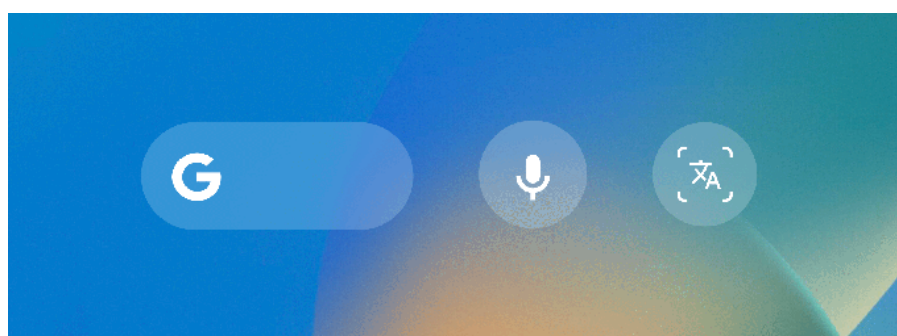


IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

Similarly, a new Chrome Lock Screen widget will allow users to start a search, including a voice search, but will also offer a button to quickly launch an incognito-mode search. It includes a widget that adds [Chrome's dino game](#), which typically appears when Chrome is offline, as a Lock Screen option, too. (While we love the dino game, we can't imagine giving up our limited Lock Screen real estate for this one — but to each their own!)

The new Google Drive Lock Screen widget, meanwhile, will allow you to open a suggested

## Newsletters

[See More](#) ↗

Subscribe for the industry's biggest tech news

### TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch's coverage.

### Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

### TechCrunch Week in Review



Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

### TechCrunch Mobility



TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).



Latest

Security

Startups

AI





Events

Podcasts

Newsletters

important. A smaller, circular widget simply displays how many new messages you have.



## Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

[REGISTER NOW](#) 8 new messages

|                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |  |
| 5                                                                                   | 0                                                                                   | 0                                                                                   | 2                                                                                   | 1                                                                                   |

8  
New  




Another app, Google Maps, is also adding Lock Screen widgets following the iOS 16 release. These will be useful for travelers and commuters as the widgets will offer real-time traffic updates and estimated travel times to places like your office or home address. Additional widgets will also let you tap to find restaurants, shops, coffee or hotels along your route.

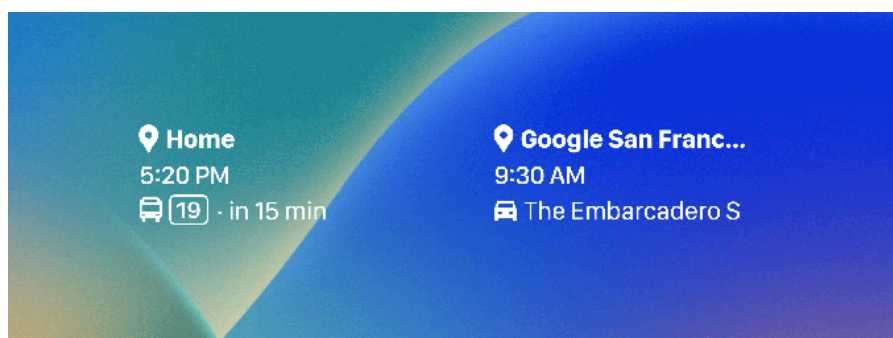


IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

Finally, a Google News widget brings short headlines to the Lock Screen, which can be tapped on to launch the Google News app.

Google had [previously launched Home Screen widgets](#) when they first became available with the launch of iOS 14 in 2020, then bringing interactive elements for many of these same apps — including Gmail, Drive, Chrome and others — to users' Home Screens. But one widget that it offers on the Home Screen is missing from this new collection of Lock Screen widgets: Google Calendar. That seems an odd oversight given that meetings and events are the sorts of at-a-glance information that many would want quick access to, like the Lock Screen provides. Hopefully, this widget's launch is just delayed but still in the works.

The company didn't offer an exact time frame for when the new Lock Screen widgets would become available, only that they'll roll out in the weeks ahead.

Topics: [Apps](#) [dashboard](#) [gmail](#) [Google](#)

[Google-Calendar](#) [iOS 16](#) [ios 16 lock screen](#)

[iPhone](#) [lock screen](#) [lock screen widgets](#)

[operating system](#) [real estate](#) [Software](#)

[user interfaces](#) [voice search](#) [widget](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [🐼](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



**Sarah Perez**

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING

APPS

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [🐼](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)

Google brings Gemini to Wear OS watches, adds AI Mode to Circle to Search



Google announced on Wednesday that it's rolling out Gemini to wear OS watches, nearly two months after [teasing the move back in May](#). The tech giant is also adding new [Circle to Search](#) capabilities by integrating its AI Mode search experience directly into the feature and adding support for gaming-related queries.

Gemini is rolling out to watches from Pixel, Samsung, OPPO, OnePlus, and Xiaomi that are running Wear OS 4+ over the coming weeks, the company says. The announcement is part of Google's plans to [replace Google Assistant with Gemini](#) across all of its devices and platforms.

IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

To start talking to Gemini, users need to say, "Hey, Google," press and hold the side button on their watch, or tap on the Gemini app icon on their watch screen.

Users will be able to ask Gemini questions like, "For how long should I roast sliced vegetables, and at what temperature?" when busy cooking with messy hands. Or a user could ask, "Do I need an umbrella today?" when heading out the door.

Additionally, users can utilize Gemini to complete tasks across multiple apps. For example, a user could ask Gemini to "Summarize my last email from Emily" or "Add my son's next five baseball games to my calendar."

## Latest in Apps

[See More](#)

### APPS



The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

Ivan Mehta - 1 hour ago

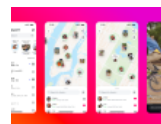
### AI



Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 13 hours ago

### APPS



Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

Aisha Malik - 18 hours ago

Google notes that users can ask Gemini to remember important details such as “Remember I parked on level 4, spot 27” or “Remind me to go grocery shopping after work.”



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

As for the new Circle to Search capabilities, Google says it’s making it easier to explore information to get quick help. [Launched last year](#), Circle to Search allows users to initiate a Google search by circling, highlighting, scribbling, or tapping on something they see on their screen.

**TC**

## Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

Now users will be able to use [AI Mode](#)'s advanced reasoning to dig into complex topics and ask follow-up questions, all without switching apps.

After starting a search with Circle to Search, an AI Overview will appear in the results. From there, users can scroll to the bottom and tap “Dive deeper with AI Mode” to ask follow-up questions and explore more about the visual search.

The company is also making it easier to use AI Mode in Google Lens, as it's now available through the Google app on both Android and iOS. The capability is now available in the U.S. and India.

In addition, Google says users can now use Circle to Search when gaming on mobile. For example, you could leverage Circle to Search to identify a new character or find a winning strategy when playing a game.

Google also announced that it's making AI Overviews more helpful, as responses are now better formatted and easier to read. The tech giant notes that AI Overviews can break down key information and include more visuals.

Last, Google announced that Pixel 9 Pro owners get a full year of the company's [Google AI Pro](#) subscription for free. This includes access to [Veo 3](#), which lets you describe an idea and to generate a short video with natural audio.

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [gemini](#) [Google](#) [wear os](#)



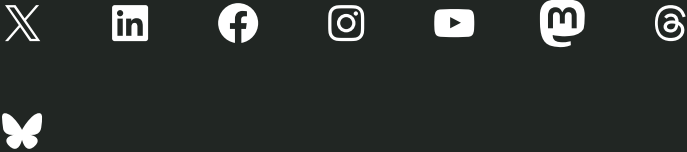
Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

[View Bio](#) >

Loading the next article



- [TechCrunch Staff](#)  
[Contact Us](#)  
[Advertise](#)  
[Crunchboard Jobs](#)  
[Site Map](#)
- [Terms of Service](#)  
[Privacy Policy](#)  
[RSS Terms of Use](#)
- [OpenAI](#)  
[Perplexity](#)  
[Cisco](#)  
[DeepMind](#)  
[Windsurf](#)  
[Tech Layoffs](#)  
[ChatGPT](#)